

it's very different from the Skype for Linux client you use today," the Skype team wrote in a blog post.

Some basic features that made Skype a popular VoIP client in the market are missing from the Skype for Linux Alpha version. These include the highly popular video-calling support and 32-bit Linux compatibility. However, Microsoft is claiming that the new app will sport a "fast and responsive Skype UI" along with some new emoticons and options to share files, photos and videos. Video calling support is also likely to be added in the coming weeks.

Unlike some dated Skype versions for the Linux platform, the new app is backed by an all new calling architecture. This new technology enhancement allows you to directly call your friends and family who are using the latest Skype apps on their Windows, Mac, iOS and Android devices but restricts the calling functionality for older versions based on the open source platform.

While Microsoft is all praises for the new features, the Linux community has criticised the delay in the release of a full-fledged Skype version for the open source operating

system. "Nice one, so you basically put Skype into a Web renderer and release it like an application," one of the Linux users commented on the Skype forums.

A community-based Skype version has reportedly been delivering a similar experience since quite a long time. Called Ghetto Skype, the open source client is available on GitHub and has been using the Electron framework to enable Web-powered VoIP support.

In addition to the new release of the Skype for Linux, Microsoft has expanded its operations on Chrome OS and Linux by providing an easier way to make free voice and video calls on Skype — without the requirement for an app or browser plugin. There is an ORTC technology that has already been offering the plugin-free calling support on Skype for Web, Outlook and Office Web apps. You just need to visit the Skype website from your Chromebook or Chrome browser on Linux to start making one-to-one and group voice calls.

The Redmond giant is also working on enabling video calls and direct calls to landlines and mobiles through Chromebook and the Chrome browser in Linux.

Google launches Android Skilling programme to train two million Indian developers

In a bid to utilise the extensive manpower in India, Google has announced the launch of its Android Skilling programme. The new initiative is aimed at training two million Indian developers over the next three years and is a major contribution towards the government's Skill India initiative.



Citing a recent research report, Google says that India will have the largest population of developers in the world by 2018, producing over four million app developers. This is indeed reason enough for the search giant to launch its new programme.

"By building a world-class curriculum and making it easily accessible to millions of students and developers in India, we want to contribute to the Skill India initiative and help make India the global leader in mobile app

development," said Caesar Sengupta, VP, product management at Google, in a statement.

The Android Skilling programme will have three major elements, including end-to-end Android training, training channels and associate Android developer certification. Google has partnered with the National Skill Development Corporation of India to integrate its in-person Android Developer training into the computer science curricula of various Indian universities.

Additionally, Google has teamed up with training partners such as Edureka, Koenig, Manipal Global, Simplilearn, Udacity and UpGrade. These partner institutions will operate as authorised Android training partners in the country and will provide students with a unified training model that has been designed by Google.

To create new career options for budding developers, Google has also introduced its job-oriented Associate Android Developer certification. This performance-based exam will come at a one-time charge of Rs 6,500, and let developers obtain certification directly through the official website.

Google's Android Skill programme emerges days after Apple announced its app centre in Bengaluru. While Google is targeting Android developers in the country, Apple is aiming to reach a large number of developers and startups who want to enhance their iOS platform.

Last year, Google and Udacity allied with Tata Trusts to kick-start their jointly designed online training courses in India. Those courses were also intended to raise Android app development from the Indian market.

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